

Economic Development Authority of Chesterfield County

Meeting Minutes

March 19, 2026

Members Attending:

Terri Cofer Beirne

Robert Vaughn*

John V. Cogbill, III

Danielle Fitz Hugh

John Hughes

Jesse Calloway

Faizan Habib

Members Absent:

None

*Attended via Teams

Others Attending:

John O'Neill, Hunton Andrews Kurth, LLP

Brendan Staley, Hunton Andrews Kurth, LLP

Mike Chernau, Senior County Attorney

Tim Davey, Timmons Group

Garrett Hart, Chesterfield Economic Development

Matt McLaren, Chesterfield Economic Development

Jake Elder, Chesterfield Economic Development

Samantha Furnish, Chesterfield Economic Development

Terri Cofer Beirne called the meeting to order at 3:03 pm and noted that a quorum was present for the Economic Development Authority meeting on March 19, 2026.

Approval of the Minutes:

Terri Cofer Beirne requested that the Authority approve the minutes of the February 19, 2026, meeting. John Hughes motioned to approve the meeting minutes as written. John Cogbill seconded, and all members present voted in the affirmative.

Financial Statements Update:

Debbie Baicy provided the February financial report, highlighting cash reserves and project funding.

Springline at District 60 Update:

Jake Elder shared a plat showing the area where the future police station will be located in the Springline development. He said the property is currently owned by the Economic Development Authority (EDA). At this time, the EDA is prepared to initiate the transfer of approximately two acres of the Springline site to the County for the police station.

Danielle Fitz Hugh motioned to authorize the Chair and Vice Chair, or either of them, to execute all such agreements associated with the transfer of approximately a two-acre site at Springline to the County for the Falling Creek Police Precinct. Faizan Habib seconded, and all members present voted in the affirmative.

Jake explained as part of the County's site planning and layout process, an existing power line easement impacts a portion of the property. While no building structures are permitted within this easement, the County has secured a license agreement allowing the area to be used for parking. This agreement was coordinated directly with Dominion Energy.

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Jake also noted that a gas transmission line runs through the Stonebridge site, adjacent to the power line corridor. The County has now successfully obtained all required easement and license agreements and is fully authorized to proceed with construction.

Garrett Hart discussed the importance of establishing a cohesive theme for the Midlothian corridor from both a marketing and pedestrian experience standpoint, consistent with the Springline signage and branding. To ensure a unified identity, staff proposed re-engaging Cooper Carry to develop a thematic approach that ties Springline into the broader corridor. This effort will be funded using the remaining proceeds from the development.

He said a proposal has been received from Cooper Carry to complete this work. In addition, a separate proposal has been developed to incorporate design elements for the planned pedestrian bridge. While earlier concepts considered a more costly stone bridge, staff are pursuing a more cost-effective steel bridge design, incorporating rail-inspired elements and branding features such as Springline graphics to maintain visual consistency across the corridor.

Meadowville Technology Park Update:

Jake Elder reported visiting the LEGO manufacturing facility site earlier in the day alongside the County's building inspections team. The project, being constructed by Gray Construction, remains on schedule. The team anticipates beginning phased turnover of portions of the approximately 1.7 million-square-foot facility to LEGO and its vendors in late fall for equipment installation, commissioning, and testing. Full operations are projected to begin in early 2027, with more than 1,000 employees expected on-site. He also noted ongoing solar infrastructure construction associated with the project. A recent announcement indicated that the total investment has increased to more than \$1.5 billion, exceeding the originally announced \$1 billion. Current projections indicate the first brick will be produced in June 2027.

Jake provided additional updates on the following projects:

- Chirisa continues construction on its third building within the campus.
- Google's data center site off Bermuda Hundred Road is actively undergoing grading, with the first building anticipated to be operational in the fourth quarter of 2027.
- Chirisa is expanding operations at its Digital Drive campus (formerly the Cartograph site).
- Civica's pharmaceutical manufacturing facility is now under roof, with interior construction progressing.

Tim Davey reported that work continues on the two active roadway improvement projects, including the perimeter road around the LEGO campus and a road-widening project. Progress has been limited over the past two months due to unfavorable weather, and there have been no significant updates since last month.

Upper Magnolia Green Update:

Tim Davey reported in 2023, the UMG project received a \$25 million state grant, which has primarily supported the design of critical infrastructure. A significant milestone was achieved in the past month with the issuance of a permit to construct a 400-acre pad site.

In 2024, the project was awarded an additional \$13 million to initiate construction activities. These funds have supported the design and construction of the Duval Road realignment, which will provide site access, as well as the development of an initial 10-acre pad for marketing purposes.

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An additional \$10.5 million in state funding has been allocated to advance other long-lead infrastructure components. These funds are being used to begin clearing within the future industrial footprint, including the western arterial collector corridor.

Tim also noted the award of \$35 million through the Transportation Partnership Opportunity Fund (TPOF). These funds will be combined with the \$10.5 million allocation to support a coordinated construction effort. The goal is to initiate a single mobilization in summer 2026 to advance both clearing and roadway construction activities.

He said over the next 12 months, Duval Road access is expected to be completed, enabling improved site visibility and access. Concurrently, substantial progress is anticipated on roadway infrastructure extending from Hull Street Road into the site.

Other Updates:

Matt McLaren reported strong overall economic development activity, noting it as likely the most robust in the past year. Several large-scale projects remain active across multiple sites, including interest in the Upper Magnolia area; however, no final site selections have been made. He highlighted the continued presence of multiple multi-billion-dollar projects in the market, reflecting positively on the County's competitiveness and recent state investment.

Matt said Berry Hill in Danville is the only other site in Virginia comparable in size to Upper Magnolia. It was reported that Berry Hill has informally indicated plans to sell the remaining acreage to a data center developer, though details remain limited. While the project appears to be primarily data center-focused, there may be some associated light manufacturing.

He also emphasized that developments of this scale typically require a significant workforce of highly skilled engineering professionals, which may present challenges in other regions. The situation at Berry Hill will continue to be monitored in coordination with state partners, with additional information expected in the coming months.

Garrett Hart reported that significant progress has been made on addressing legislative concerns related to data center policy and land-use and zoning issues affecting housing. Many of the previously problematic provisions have either been removed or revised to a more acceptable level through collaboration among regional and state partners. Staff noted ongoing differences between the Governor and the General Assembly regarding data center policy, tax incentives, and related economic development strategies. The Governor has expressed support for maintaining existing incentive commitments, while legislative actions have moved in the opposite direction.

He said the main discussions have now shifted to the state budget, where key decisions remain unresolved. The recent delay in the budget process provides the Governor with an opportunity to propose a revised budget that aligns more closely with these priorities, including continued support for economic development initiatives such as state marketing and site selection.

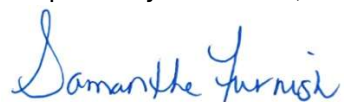
There being no further business, Danielle Fitz Hugh motioned to conclude the meeting at 3:46 pm. John Hughes seconded, and all members present voted in the affirmative.

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Respectfully submitted,

A handwritten signature in blue ink that reads "Samantha Furnish". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Samantha Furnish

Recording Secretary

Next Meeting: April 16, 2026, at 3 pm